USER JOURNEY · APPRENTICESHIPS & GROUP TRAINING

From jobseeker to qualified tradesperson

One apprentice's path from first application to a completed qualification, across a group training platform and an apprenticeship support platform, and every person who touches it on the way.

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Introduction

In Australia, many apprentices are employed by a **Group Training Organisation (GTO)**, which recruits them, employs them and places them with a **host employer**. Separately, an **apprenticeship support network provider** signs up the training contract, registers it with the government and manages incentives and progress check-ins. Two organisations and two platforms serve the same apprentice.

Group training platform

Used by the GTO to recruit candidates, place them with host employers, run field visits on mobile, track safety, pay apprentices and invoice hosts.

Used by: GTO recruiters, field officers, payroll and finance

Apprenticeship support platform

Used by the support network provider to sign up training contracts, sync registrations with the government system, schedule progress contacts and process incentive claims.

Used by: provider field and monitoring officers, plus employer, training-provider and apprentice portals

Two systems, one apprentice. The platforms are separate systems. The handoff between them happens through the **training contract**: the GTO hires, the support provider signs up and registers, and both then support the apprentice through to completion.

The people in the journey

Five parties, each with a different goal. The journey only works when all five are served.

Jordan, the apprentice

17, finishing school, wants an electrical apprenticeship. Needs a job, a clear path and someone checking in.

Illustrative persona

The GTO

Jordan's legal employer. Recruits, places, pays and supports apprentices, and carries the safety obligations.

The host employer

A local electrical contractor. Supervises Jordan on site and pays the GTO a charge-out rate.

The support provider

Government-contracted to sign up and register training contracts, check in on progress and process incentives.

Government & training authority

Approves the training contract, holds the official registration and pays incentives.

Group training platform · Apprenticeship support platform · Outside both platforms

Journey map

Seven stages, read left to right. Each cell shows what that party does at that stage, coloured by where it happens.

	1 Attract	2 Assess	3 Place	4 Sign up	5 Support	6 Pay & claim	7 Complete
Apprentice	Finds the ad and applies online	Does the aptitude test and interviews	Accepts the offer and completes induction	Signs the training contract	Works on site, studies with the training provider	Paid wages by the GTO; may receive allowances	Earns the qualification
GTO	Posts the vacancy to job boards and its careers page	Screens, assesses, interviews and markets candidates to hosts	Creates the placement, contract and safety induction; assigns a field officer	Engages the support provider to sign up the contract	Field visits on mobile, safety records, scheduled follow-ups	Runs payroll, invoices the host, tracks claims	Records completion and awards
Host employer	Asks the GTO for an apprentice	Interviews the shortlist	Takes Jordan on site		Supervises day to day	Pays the GTO's charge-out invoices	May offer ongoing work
Support provider				Sign-up wizard, signing, lodging with the training authority	Progress contacts and mentoring at set milestones	Assesses and processes incentive claims	Completion contact and completion claim
Government				Approves the contract; registration created in the government system		Pays incentives	Records the completed registration

Stage by stage

What happens at each stage, what matters most to the people involved, and how each platform helps.

1 Attract

Group training platform

A host employer asks the GTO for an electrical apprentice. The GTO creates a vacancy from a template, gets it approved, and publishes it to job boards and its own careers page. Jordan finds it and applies online.

MOMENT THAT MATTERS

Jordan's first impression: a simple application that works on a phone.

HOW THE PLATFORM HELPS

Vacancy templates, approval workflow and job-board publishing from one record.

2 Assess & select

Group training platform

Applications move through a status lifecycle. The GTO screens applicants, runs aptitude assessments, schedules interviews from the vacancy, and markets strong candidates to other hosts through reverse marketing.

MOMENT THAT MATTERS

Fast feedback. Good candidates drop out when they wait.

HOW THE PLATFORM HELPS

Bulk status changes, interview scheduling and potential-candidate matching on the vacancy.

3 Place

Group training platform

Jordan accepts. The GTO creates a placement that links Jordan to the host, with host and field details, contract dates, induction and a safety (WHS) record, and assigns a field officer. An action plan schedules the first events and reminders.

MOMENT THAT MATTERS

A safe first day: induction done and the right supervisor named.

HOW THE PLATFORM HELPS

Placement record as the single source of truth; action plans with a preview before they're applied.

4 Sign up

Apprenticeship support platform · Handoff

The support provider takes over the paperwork. A sign-up moves from lead, through information gathering, to signing by the employer and apprentice. It's then lodged with the state training authority and, once approved, the registration is created in the government system and synced back.

Lead → Sign-up → Signed → Lodged → Approved → **Registered**

MOMENT THAT MATTERS

Getting the contract right first time. A returned contract delays incentives and support.

HOW THE PLATFORM HELPS

A guided sign-up wizard, and registrations that sync from the government system instead of being keyed by hand.

5 Support & monitor

Group training · Apprenticeship support

Both organisations check in, for different reasons. The GTO's field officer visits Jordan on site on a set schedule, filling in forms on mobile that save even with patchy reception, and logs any safety incidents. The support provider runs progress contacts at fixed milestones, with mentoring where it's needed.

Sign-up	7 weeks	3 months	7 months	18 months	24 months	36 months	Completion

MOMENT THAT MATTERS

The early months, when timely support makes the biggest difference.

HOW THE PLATFORMS HELP

Visit schedules with bulk officer assignment; progress contacts created automatically for every registration.

6 Pay & claim

Group training · Apprenticeship support

The GTO pays Jordan through payroll, invoices the host employer, and tracks its own claims against the apprenticeship. The support provider assesses and processes government incentive claims, such as commencement and completion incentives and the living-away-from-home allowance, with due dates calculated from the registration.

MOMENT THAT MATTERS

Employers only stay in the system if incentives arrive on time.

HOW THE PLATFORMS HELP

Invoices and claims on the placement; claim forecasting and an employer self-service portal.

7 Complete

Group training · Apprenticeship support

Jordan finishes the qualification. The support provider runs the completion contact and completion claim, the government records the registration as completed, and the GTO records the outcome and awards. The host may offer Jordan ongoing work.

MOMENT THAT MATTERS

A clean finish: qualification, final incentive and a job.

HOW THE PLATFORMS HELP

Completion recorded in both systems, with awards and certificates on the candidate record.

Handoffs & opportunities

Journeys break at the handoffs. These are the points where responsibility moves between people or systems, and where a product team can make the biggest difference.

Handoff	Risk	Opportunity
Applicant → placement	Details captured during recruitment are re-checked or re-entered when the placement is created.	Carry the candidate record straight into the placement, with nothing re-keyed.
GTO → support provider	Two separate systems. Apprentice and employer details are entered again for the sign-up.	Explore a data handoff between the platforms to cut duplicate entry and contract returns.
Government → both	Registration status lives in the government system; the GTO may only learn about changes later.	Surface registration status and milestones to the GTO's field officer.
Two sets of check-ins	The field officer and the support provider both contact the apprentice, sometimes close together.	Share a visit and contact timeline so check-ins complement each other.

💡 **A product insight:** each platform serves its own organisation well. The biggest remaining gains for the apprentice are in the space *between* them.

My role

I spent **nine years on the group training platform** (2015 – 2024) as a QA engineer, business analyst and product owner, so stages 1 – 3 and the GTO side of 5 – 7 come from first-hand product work. I mapped the support provider's side from its product documentation, to show the journey the apprentice actually lives through.

PRODUCT MANAGER

Looked at the journey, not just one product

- Framed the apprentice's end-to-end path across two organisations and two platforms.
- Identified the handoffs as the biggest opportunity, starting with duplicate data entry between the GTO and the support provider.
- Tied each stage to a moment that matters, so priorities follow what the apprentice and employer need most.

What I produced: Journey map · Opportunity areas

BUSINESS ANALYST

Mapped every party, stage and handoff

- Defined five parties and their goals, and placed every activity in a stage and a system.
- Documented the sign-up lifecycle, the progress-contact milestones and the claim flows.
- Drew on years of requirements work on recruitment, placements, field visits, safety records, invoicing and claims.

What I produced: Swimlane map · Stage definitions

QUALITY & TESTING

Tested the journey the way users live it

- Tested recruitment, placement, field-visit and claim workflows on the group training platform across many releases.
- Used journeys like this one to plan end-to-end and regression testing across connected workflows, not just single screens.
- Treated handoffs as high-risk areas that deserve their own test scenarios.

What I produced: End-to-end scenarios · Regression focus

7	5	2	9
journey stages	parties served	platforms, one apprentice	years on the group training platform

Summary

The apprentice journey, at a glance.

Stage	What happens
1 · Attract	The GTO advertises a host's vacancy, and Jordan applies online.
2 · Assess	Screening, aptitude assessment, interviews and reverse marketing.
3 · Place	Placement with the host employer, induction, safety record and field officer.
4 · Sign up	The support provider signs up, lodges and registers the training contract.
5 · Support	Field visits from the GTO; progress contacts and mentoring from the support provider.
6 · Pay & claim	Payroll and host invoicing; government incentive claims.
7 · Complete	Qualification, completion claim, awards and ongoing work.

🚀 **The takeaway:** an apprenticeship is a multi-year journey shared by five parties and two platforms. Designing for the whole journey, especially the handoffs, is what turns good software into a good apprenticeship.